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DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

Project Report

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Academic Year	2024–2025

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1. Introduction

In today's rapidly evolving digital world, the ability to effectively navigate, evaluate, and create using digital technologies has become an essential life skill. Digital literacy encompasses a wide range of competencies from understanding online safety and email communication to coding skills and professional digital presence.

This project was undertaken as part of the Digital Literacy curriculum at VIT Bhopal University. The portfolio consists of five structured tasks designed to build practical digital skills: creating an infographic, setting up professional digital profiles, practising on a coding platform, drafting professional emails, and researching a cybercrime case study.

All deliverables are organised and submitted through a GitHub repository named **digital-literacy-project**, reflecting industry-standard practices for version control and documentation. This report summarises each task, the tools used, the process followed, and key learnings.

2. Task 1 – Infographic on Digital Literacy

Tool Used: Canva (canva.com)

For Task 1, I designed a visually appealing infographic on the theme of Digital Literacy using Canva, a free browser-based graphic design tool. Canva offers a wide variety of templates, icons, and colour schemes that make it accessible even for beginners with no prior design experience.

Content Covered:

- Definition and importance of digital literacy in the modern world.
- Safe internet practices — strong passwords, avoiding phishing links, and enabling two-factor authentication.
- Essential student tools — writing professionally, using appropriate subject lines, and maintaining respectful tone.

The infographic was designed with a clean layout, colour-coded sections, and short bullet points to maximise readability. It was exported as a PNG file and uploaded to the **task-1-presentation** folder in the GitHub repository.

Difficulty Faced: The primary challenge was selecting a layout that could present three distinct topics on a single page without making it look cluttered. I experimented with two or three different Canva templates before settling on a three-column vertical infographic

format that gave each topic its own visual space while maintaining a unified design language throughout.

3. Task 2 – Digital Profile Creation

Task 2 involved creating and completing professional digital profiles on three major platforms to establish an online presence relevant to academic and career goals.

GitHub — Version control, project hosting, and developer portfolio.

Created a profile README repository (a special repository that shares the same name as the username). Added structured information including Name, Branch, Registration Number, Year of Study, and Career Goal. GitHub serves as the primary submission platform for this project and will continue to be used for hosting coding projects throughout the degree programme.

LinkedIn — Professional networking and career development.

Set up a LinkedIn profile with accurate educational details including the institution (VIT Bhopal), degree programme, and expected year of graduation. LinkedIn is widely used by recruiters and industry professionals, making it a critical platform for future internship and job applications.

Kaggle — Data science learning, competitions, and community.

Created a basic Kaggle profile. Kaggle provides access to datasets, notebooks, and machine learning competitions, which will be valuable for developing data skills in later stages of the programme.

Screenshots of all three profiles were taken and uploaded to the **task-2-portfolio** folder. These profiles collectively form the foundation of a growing professional digital identity.

4. Task 3 – Coding Platform & Google Form

Part A: Coding on HackerRank

I created an account on HackerRank, one of the most widely used platforms for practising programming and technical interview preparation. I solved the introductory problem **'Solve Me First'**, which involved an integer, n, perform conditional functions. Although simple, this task demonstrated the process of reading the problem statement, writing a solution, and submitting it for automated evaluation a workflow fundamental to competitive programming.

A screenshot of the accepted solution was taken and uploaded to the **task-3-platforms** folder in the repository.

Part B: Google Form – Digital Literacy Quiz

I created a Google Form titled **'Digital Literacy Quiz'** containing five questions to test basic awareness of digital tools and safe online behaviour. The form included:

- One Multiple Choice Question (MCQ) — testing knowledge of safe password practices.
- One Short Answer Question — asking respondents to define digital literacy in their own words.
- Three additional questions covering email etiquette, cybercrime awareness, and online safety.

The form was linked to a Google Sheets spreadsheet using the Responses tab, enabling automatic collection and organisation of responses. Screenshots of both the form and the linked response sheet were uploaded to the task folder. The shareable form link was also added to the repository README for easy access.

5. Task 4 – Email Etiquette & Social Media Checklist

Part A: Professional Email Drafts

I drafted two professional emails demonstrating correct email etiquette in different academic and professional contexts. **Email 1** was addressed to a professor, requesting an extension on an assignment submission with a valid reason stated politely. **Email 2** was addressed to a company HR representative, expressing interest in an internship opportunity. Both emails followed proper structure: subject line, salutation, body, closing, and signature. They were saved and uploaded to the **task-4-email-etiquette** folder.

Part B: Social Media Safety Checklist

I created a checklist file (**social-media-checklist.txt**) outlining best practices for safe and responsible social media use. Key Do's included using strong passwords, thinking before posting, and keeping profiles professional. Key Don'ts included sharing personal information publicly, posting offensive content, and clicking unverified links.

Reflection: A common example of poor digital communication is sending a casual, abbreviation-heavy message to a professor (e.g., 'pls extend deadline asap') this fails to convey respect, provide context, or follow any professional structure, and is likely to be ignored or create a negative impression.

6. Task 5 – Cybercrime Case Study: Ransomware Attack

Part A: Case Study Summary

Ransomware is a type of malicious software (malware) that encrypts a victim's files or locks them out of their system, then demands a ransom payment often in cryptocurrency in exchange for restoring access. It represents one of the most damaging and rapidly growing forms of cybercrime globally.

A typical ransomware attack follows these steps: the attacker sends a phishing email with a malicious attachment or link; the victim clicks it, unknowingly installing the malware; the ransomware silently encrypts files across the system and network drives; a ransom note appears demanding payment within a deadline. Targets include hospitals, government agencies, educational institutions, and individual users. Consequences range from data loss and financial damage to complete operational shutdowns.

Part B: Prevention Checklist

- Use strong, unique passwords and change them regularly.
- Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) on all important accounts.
- Never share OTPs, passwords, or banking details with anyone.
- Verify links and sender addresses before clicking or opening attachments.
- Keep operating systems and antivirus software up to date.
- Use only secure, trusted applications from official sources.
- Report any cyber fraud immediately to cybercrime.gov.in or call Helpline 1930.

7. Conclusion

This Digital Literacy Portfolio has been a comprehensive and practical learning experience. Across five tasks, I developed skills in graphic design, professional online presence, coding, email communication, and cybersecurity awareness all of which are increasingly essential in today's digital-first world.

Working with tools like Canva, GitHub, LinkedIn, HackerRank, and Google Forms provided hands-on familiarity with platforms used by professionals and students worldwide. The cybercrime task, in particular, reinforced the importance of digital safety and responsible online behaviour.

This portfolio is organised and submitted via GitHub as a demonstration of version control and structured project management — skills that will be invaluable throughout my academic and professional journey at VIT Bhopal and beyond.